



▲ TOKAREV SVT40

Date 1940

Origin Soviet Union

Weight 3.9kg (8½lb)

Barrel 61cm (24in)

Calibre 7.62mm × 54R

During the 1930s the Soviet designers worked on the development of a self-loading rifle, and this led to the introduction of the SVT40 – usually issued to NCOs or trained marksmen.



▲ M1 CARBINE

Date 1941

Origin US

Weight 2.4kg (5¼lb)

Barrel 46cm (18in)

Calibre .30in Carbine

The M1 carbine was a popular lightweight weapon. It used an intermediate cartridge, the power of which was between that of a rifle and pistol. It was also produced with a folding butt for paratroopers.



▲ GEWEHR 43

Date 1943

Origin Germany

Weight 4.35kg (9½lb)

Barrel 56cm (22in)

Calibre 7.92mm × 57

The German army's request for a self-loading rifle to increase infantry firepower led to the introduction of the successful Gewehr 43. A number of them were fitted with telescopic sights and used as sniper rifles.



▲ STURMGEGWEHR 44

Date 1943

Origin Germany

Weight 5.1kg (11¼lb)

Barrel 41.8cm (16½in)

Calibre 7.92mm × 33 Kurz

One of the most influential firearms of the 20th century, the StG 44 was manufactured using pressed steel that was easier to produce. Its medium-powered cartridge enabled properly controlled automatic fire.

▼ MOSIN-NAGANT CARBINE M1944

Date 1944

Origin Soviet Union

Weight 3.9kg (8½lb)

Barrel 51.7cm (20¼in)

Calibre 7.62mm × 54R

In 1910, the Mosin-Nagant rifle was modified to produce a carbine by shortening its barrel. In 1938 it was revamped, and in 1944, it attained its final form with the addition of a folding bayonet.



Folding cruciform bayonet